Charter Schools Update

Teaching, Learning, and Enrollment Committee Meeting



PORTLAND
Public Schools

May 14, 2026

Charter Schools Agenda

- Role of PPS as Sponsor
- Support & Accountability
- Overview – Charter Schools
- Academic Data - Charter Schools
- Charter School Demographics
- Questions

Role of Charter School Sponsor

District Responsibilities:

- Approve or deny annual applicants for the establishment of new PPS charter schools
- *Recently received one Letter of Intent to apply to become a charter school 2027
- Conduct ongoing monitoring, oversight, and annual evaluation of PPS charter schools
- Pass through State School Funding and other funding sources
- Monitor the implementation of interventions for under-performing schools
- Provide resources, access to information, data systems, professional development, and cost-neutral assistance
- Advocate and act as a liaison for the District in its role as a charter school authorizer
- Promote equity and learning for all students

Charter Schools – Support & Accountability

Annual Calendar of Deliverables

- Academic
  - Performance Plan (October)
  - Report Card Data analysis (Fall)
  - Performance Framework (January)
  - Local assessment data reporting (Spring)
  - Year-end report on charter schools to PPS Board committee (Late Spring)
- Fiscal
  - Quarterly Financial Report
  - Draft budget for upcoming school year (May)
  - Finalized Budget (September)
  - Annual Municipal Audit (Fall)
- Operational
  - Site visits (monthly)
  - Formal annual site visit with stakeholders (Spring)
  - Charter school board meeting observation and review (Winter & Spring)
  - Review of compliance submissions (monthly)

Charter Schools Overview

Seven Charter Schools are located within PPS Boundaries

Five PPS Sponsored Charter Schools (1,297 students)

- K-5
  - The Emerson School
  - KairosPDX Learning Academy
  - Portland Arthur Academy
- K-8
  - Le Monde French Immersion
  - Portland Village School

Two State-Sponsored Charter Schools, both K-8 (~400 students)

- Cottonwood School of Civics and Science
- The Ivy School

Charter School Overview

SCHOOL	MODEL	GRADES	OPEN DATE	CONTRACT LENGTH	CURRENT ENROLLMENT	FACILITY STATUS
KairosPDX	Eliminate racial achievement gap	K-5	2014	July 2020-June 2030	173	Lease PPS building – North Portland
Le Monde French Immersion	French Immersion	K-8	2012	July 2023-June 2033	383	Stable lease - SE Portland
Portland Arthur Academy	Direct Instruction	K-5	2005	July 2021-June 2031	165	Stable lease - SE Portland
Portland Village School	Waldorf inspired	K-8	2007	July 2020-June 2030	436	Purchased building 2024. SW Waterfront
The Emerson School	The Project Approach/ Positive Discipline	K-5	2003	July 2019-June 2029	140	Built out new school 2023-24. 15 year lease with 5 year option. Downtown
Cottonwood School	Place based learning	K-8	ODE	State sponsored	107	State sponsored
Ivy School	Montessori	K-8	ODE	State sponsored	287	State sponsored

Charter School Academic Data

CHARTER SCHOOL	24-25 OSAS GRADES 3-5			24-25 OSAS GRADES 6-8			ADDITIONAL INFORMATION
	ELA	MATH	COMPARED TO PPS	ELA	MATH	COMPARED TO PPS	
The Emerson School	66.7%	54.2%	+8.5% ELA +0.5% MATH				In both 2023-24 and 2024-25, Emerson met performance targets in both ELA and Math for all measurable student populations.
KairosPDX	24%	20%	-34.2% ELA -33.7% MATH	Grades 3-5 AA ELA -5.2%	Grades 3-5 AA MATH -7.1%		Black students at Kairos outperform the District in ELA and Math for grades 3-5 by 1.2%.* Title 1 for 25-26. *metric based on 3 year average
Portland Arthur Academy	69.4%	54.2%	+11.2% ELA +0.5% MATH				PAA regular attenders rate (92%) was an 11.1% increase over 2023-24 and exceeds the District's regular attenders rate by 17.4%. Title 1 for 25-26.
Le Monde French Immersion	84%	87%	+25.8% ELA +33.3% MATH	89.2%	83.3%	+31.9% ELA +35.5% MATH	100% of Le Monde graduates meet high school language credit requirements prior to starting 9th grade.
Portland Village School	39.8%	35.3%	-18.4% ELA -18.4% MATH	61.2%	52.4%	+3.9% ELA +4.6% MATH	Grade 6-8 Students with Disabilities outperform the District by 12.4% in ELA and 15.6% in Math. Grade 6-8 Historically Underserved Students by Race/Ethnicity outperform the District by 22.1% in ELA and 26.6% in Math.

Charter School Demographics (October 1, 2025)

Charter School	Enrollment	Direct Certification		SpEd		Multilingual Learner		Historically Underserved		Black		Latino		Native American		Pacific Islander		Multi-Race	
	#	#	%	#	%	#	%	#	%	#	%	#	%	#	%	#	%	#	%
Emerson	139	38	27.3	33	23.7	4	2.9	36	25.9	5	3.6	20	14.4	n/a	n/a	2	1.4	9	6.5
KairosPDX	178	94	52.8	28	15.7	3	1.7	167	93.8	116	65.2	18	10.1	n/a	n/a	2	1.1	31	17.4
Le Monde	385	35	9.1	45	11.7	5	1.3	53	13.8	9	2.3	22	5.7	1	0.3	n/a	n/a	21	5.5
PAA	167	49	29.3	18	10.8	30	18	48	28.7	25	15	16	9.6	1	0.6	n/a	n/a	6	3.6
PVS	434	124	28.6	81	18.7	13	3	102	23.5	9	2.1	60	13.8	2	0.5	n/a	n/a	31	7.1
PPS K-5	19,071	6,185	32.4	3,606	18.9	2,350	12.3	6,792	35.6	1,509	7.9	3,608	18.9	118	0.6	174	0.9	1,383	7.3
PPS Middle Schools	7,360	2,365	32.1	1,190	16.2	724	9.8	2,505	34	580	7.9	1,319	17.9	32	0.4	61	0.8	513	7

PPS Enrollment Reports Website

Contact us

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